

# Ankle sprain

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**Archive note:** English text snapshot of the official patient-information webpage. Navigation was removed; the medical content was not translated.

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An ankle sprain is an injury that can cause the soft tissues that surround the ankle joint to overstretch.

Ligaments are tough bands of tissue which connect the bones of the leg to the foot, holding together the ankle joint and providing support. They have boundaries which they can stretch to, and when stretched beyond this, it can result in a tear.

The most common injury occurs to the ligaments on the outside of the ankle, known as the lateral ligament complex. You can also injure the ligaments on the inside of your ankle (medial ligament complex), and very occasionally, above your ankle joint in between your tibia and fibula (syndesmosis).

The ligament affected usually depends on which direction your foot is forced into during the initial injury.

How does a sprained ankle happen?

## **What are the symptoms of an ankle sprain?**

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